

What is md file in agent building

An *.md* file is a *Markdown file* — a plain text document formatted with simple symbols to create structured content like headings, lists, code blocks, links, and tables.

In AI agent building, *.md* files are commonly used for:

- *Agent instructions / system prompts*
- *Documentation*
- *Tool descriptions*
- *Memory/context files*
- *Workflow definitions*
- *Project READMEs*

Markdown is popular because it's:

- *Human-readable*
- *Easy for LLMs to parse*
- *Version-control friendly (works well with Git)*
- *Lightweight compared to Word or PDFs*

Example of a simple Markdown file:

Customer Support Agent

Role

You are a helpful customer support assistant.

Rules

- *Be concise*
- *Never reveal API keys*
- *Escalate billing issues*

Tools

- *CRM lookup*
- *Email sender*

Common Markdown syntax:

Heading 1

Heading 2

*****bold*****

italic

- *Bullet item*

1. *Numbered item*

`` inline code ``

`` `` ` python`

`print("hello")`

In agent frameworks like:

- *[LangChain](https://www.langchain.com?utm_source=chatgpt.com)*

- *[OpenAI Agents SDK](https://openai.github.io/openai-agents-python/?utm_source=chatgpt.com)*

- *[CrewAI](https://www.crewai.com?utm_source=chatgpt.com)*

- *[AutoGen](https://microsoft.github.io/autogen/?utm_source=chatgpt.com)*

`.md` files are often used to:

- *Store prompts*

- *Define personas*

- *Explain architecture*

- *Keep operational playbooks*

- *Provide retrieval knowledge for RAG systems*

Typical files in an AI agent project:

`` `` ` text`

`/project`

`└─ README.md`

`└─ prompts/`

`| └─ planner.md`

`| └─ researcher.md`

`| └─ critic.md`

`└─ memory.md`

`└─ tools.md`

A few especially common Markdown files:

- *README.md* → project overview
- *CONTRIBUTING.md* → contribution guide
- *SYSTEM_PROMPT.md* → agent behavior rules
- *MEMORY.md* → persistent context for the agent

To create one:

- Windows: Notepad → save as file.md
- Mac/Linux: any text editor
- VS Code is the most common editor for AI projects:
[Visual Studio Code](#)

You can preview Markdown nicely in:

- GitHub
- VS Code
- Obsidian
- Notion

If you want, I can also show:

- how .md files are used in real AI agents,
- best structure for prompt files,
- or how to connect Markdown files to RAG/vector databases.

TDLR

.md = Markdown file.

It's a simple text file used in AI agent projects to write:

- prompts
- instructions
- documentation
- memory/context

Example:

AI Agent

You are a coding assistant.

- Be concise
- Explain code clearly

Common in tools like:

- [LangChain](#)
- [CrewAI](#)
- [OpenAI Agents SDK](#)

Think of it as a clean, readable notes/instructions file for agents.

Difference in General Prompt and TL;DR

A general prompt gives the AI full instructions in normal detail.

A TL;DR prompt (“Too Long; Didn’t Read”) is a short, compressed version of the same instructions.

Example:

General Prompt

You are a customer support assistant.
 Answer politely and clearly.
 If the issue is billing-related, escalate it.
 Never mention internal policies.
 Keep responses under 150 words.

TL;DR Prompt

Polite support bot. Escalate billing. No internal policies. <150 words.

Difference:

General Prompt	TL;DR Prompt
Detailed	Short
Easier to understand	Faster to read/use
Better for complex tasks	Good for quick reuse
More reliable behavior	May lose nuance

In agent building:

- Use general prompts for important/system behavior.

- *Use TL;DR prompts for summaries, memory compression, or quick reusable instructions.*